

Daily MLB Betting Edge Report - May 18, 2026

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Executive Summary

- Slate checked: 14 MLB scheduled games from MLB StatsAPI; 14 Bovada events matched for today's date.
- Candidates scored: 250; top 50 are curated by model EV, probability edge, sample quality, and correlation control.
- Core inputs: current-season team form, probable starters, pitcher K/BF, opponent K/PA, hitter game-log hit/TB/H+R+RBI rates, and live Bovada prices.
- Practical note: verify lineups, scratches, pitcher changes, weather, and price movement before betting.

Top 20 Bets And Props

#	Conf	Market	Pick	Odds	Model	Impl	Edge	EV	Fair	Why
1	A	Player prop	Drew Romo RBI (Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners)	350	38.2%	22.2%	+16.0 pts	+0.72	162	13 current games, 3 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Chicago White Sox projected runs.
2	A	Player prop	Chase Meidroth Run (Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners)	220	51.7%	31.2%	+20.4 pts	+0.65	-107	44 current games, 119 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Chicago White Sox projected runs.
3	A	Pitcher strikeouts	Sonny Gray Under 3.5 K (Boston Red Sox @ Kansas City Royals)	135	67.7%	39.8%	+27.9 pts	+0.59	-210	Projected 2.87 Ks from 19.3 BF; pitcher K/BF 15.1% vs opponent K/PA 21.3%.
4	A	Total	Over 7.0 (Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners)	-115	77.4%	51.1%	+26.3 pts	+0.45	-343	Projected total 9.5; starter and recent team run rates drive the number.
5	A	Runline	Minnesota Twins (Houston Astros @ Minnesota Twins)	170	51.8%	35.7%	+16.1 pts	+0.40	-107	Projected margin +1.69 for Minnesota Twins; run environment 8.5.
6	A	Pitcher strikeouts	Zac Gallen Under 3.5 K (San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks)	120	62.2%	42.5%	+19.7 pts	+0.37	-165	Projected 3.11 Ks from 21.4 BF; pitcher K/BF 15.0% vs opponent K/PA 21.0%.
7	A	Player prop	Miguel Vargas Run (Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners)	150	54.9%	40.0%	+14.9 pts	+0.37	-122	45 current games, 138 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Chicago White Sox projected runs.
8	A	Total	Under 9.0 (Boston Red Sox @ Kansas City Royals)	-105	68.8%	48.9%	+19.8 pts	+0.34	-220	Projected total 7.4; starter and recent team run rates drive the number.
9	A	Player prop	Drake Baldwin RBI (Atlanta Braves @ Miami Marlins)	170	49.1%	37.0%	+12.1 pts	+0.33	104	47 current games, 123 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Atlanta Braves projected runs.
10	A	Pitcher strikeouts	Andrew Painter Under 4.5 K (Cincinnati Reds @ Philadelphia Phillies)	105	63.1%	45.9%	+17.2 pts	+0.29	-171	Projected 3.99 Ks from 21.6 BF; pitcher K/BF 17.6% vs opponent K/PA 23.1%.
11	A	Player prop	Brayan Rocchio RBI (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	250	37.9%	28.6%	+9.3 pts	+0.33	164	46 current games, 114 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Cleveland Guardians projected runs.
12	A	Total	Under 10.0 (Texas Rangers @ Colorado Rockies)	-115	68.8%	51.1%	+17.7 pts	+0.29	-221	Projected total 8.4; starter and recent team run rates drive the number.
13	A	Moneyline	Cleveland Guardians (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	123	58.2%	43.0%	+15.2 pts	+0.30	-139	Projected Cleveland Guardians 4.7, Detroit Tigers 3.9; season/last-10 run blend supports Cleveland Guardians.
14	A	Pitcher strikeouts	Trevor Rogers Under 4.5 K (Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays)	-145	75.1%	55.4%	+19.7 pts	+0.27	-302	Projected 3.36 Ks from 19.5 BF; pitcher K/BF 19.5% vs opponent K/PA 18.3%.
15	B	Player prop	Travis Bazzana 2+ Hits (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	430	24.9%	18.9%	+6.0 pts	+0.32	302	17 current games, 0 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Cleveland Guardians projected runs.

#	Conf	Market	Pick	Odds	Model	Impl	Edge	EV	Fair	Why
16	B	Player prop	Teoscar Hernandez 2+ Hits (Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres)	390	26.6%	20.4%	+6.2 pts	+0.30	276	42 current games, 144 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Los Angeles Dodgers projected runs.
17	B	Player prop	Daulton Varsho 2+ Hits (Toronto Blue Jays @ New York Yankees)	410	25.6%	19.6%	+6.0 pts	+0.30	291	43 current games, 76 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Toronto Blue Jays projected runs.
18	A	Runline	Tampa Bay Rays (Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays)	145	51.6%	39.3%	+12.3 pts	+0.26	-107	Projected margin +1.67 for Tampa Bay Rays; run environment 8.8.
19	A	Player prop	Jonathan Aranda RBI (Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays)	195	43.3%	33.9%	+9.4 pts	+0.28	131	45 current games, 106 prior-year games; adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and Tampa Bay Rays projected runs.
20	A	Pitcher strikeouts	Robbie Ray Over 4.5 K (San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks)	105	60.6%	45.9%	+14.6 pts	+0.24	-154	Projected 5.27 Ks from 22.7 BF; pitcher K/BF 24.1% vs opponent K/PA 20.4%.

Top 20 Home Run Batter Bets

Separate HR-only card using live HR prices, hitter power form, opposing starter damage profile, projected team runs, ballpark tendency, and forecast-hour weather.

#	Conf	Batter	Odds	Model	Impl	Edge	EV	Fair	Matchup Context
1	B	Gavin Sheets HR (Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres)	775	16.6%	11.4%	+5.1 pts	+0.45	504	9 HR in 41 current games, 19 prior-year HR, 5 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.1%, SLG allowed 0.399; Petco Park 0.94x HR context (wind helping carry, 62F).
2	Spec	Harrison Bader HR (San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks)	1100	13.4%	8.3%	+5.0 pts	+0.61	647	4 HR in 20 current games, 17 prior-year HR, 3 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 3.1%, SLG allowed 0.463; Chase Field 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
3	B	Drew Romo HR (Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners)	900	14.0%	10.0%	+4.0 pts	+0.40	615	4 HR in 13 current games, 0 prior-year HR, 2 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.8%, SLG allowed 0.362; T-Mobile Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
4	B	Angel Martinez HR (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	775	14.5%	11.4%	+3.1 pts	+0.27	588	9 HR in 40 current games, 11 prior-year HR, 4 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.2%, SLG allowed 0.363; Comerica Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
5	B	Corbin Carroll HR (San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks)	650	16.1%	13.3%	+2.8 pts	+0.21	521	7 HR in 43 current games, 31 prior-year HR, 3 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.9%, SLG allowed 0.425; Chase Field 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
6	B	Ildemaro Vargas HR (San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks)	725	14.8%	12.1%	+2.7 pts	+0.22	576	7 HR in 38 current games, 3 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.9%, SLG allowed 0.425; Chase Field 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
7	C	Bryce Harper HR (Cincinnati Reds @ Philadelphia Phillies)	410	20.7%	19.6%	+1.1 pts	+0.05	384	12 HR in 46 current games, 27 prior-year HR, 3 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 5.4%, SLG allowed 0.570; Citizens Bank Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
8	B	Liam Hicks HR (Atlanta Braves @ Miami Marlins)	750	14.3%	11.8%	+2.5 pts	+0.21	602	9 HR in 44 current games, 6 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.3%, SLG allowed 0.377; loanDepot park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
9	B	Jonathan Aranda HR (Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays)	775	13.9%	11.4%	+2.4 pts	+0.21	622	8 HR in 45 current games, 14 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 3.2%, SLG allowed 0.453; Tropicana Field 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
10	Spec	Amed Rosario HR (Toronto Blue Jays @ New York Yankees)	1000	12.6%	9.1%	+3.5 pts	+0.38	696	4 HR in 26 current games, 6 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.0%, SLG allowed 0.415; Yankee Stadium 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
11	B	Chase DeLauter HR (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	875	12.3%	10.3%	+2.0 pts	+0.20	714	7 HR in 43 current games, 0 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.2%, SLG allowed 0.363; Comerica Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
12	B	Brandon Valenzuela HR (Toronto Blue Jays @ New York Yankees)	800	13.4%	11.1%	+2.3 pts	+0.20	648	4 HR in 25 current games, 0 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 3.3%, SLG allowed 0.365; Yankee Stadium 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
13	Spec	Travis Bazzana HR (Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers)	1300	10.4%	7.1%	+3.3 pts	+0.46	860	1 HR in 17 current games, 0 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.2%, SLG allowed 0.363; Comerica Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
14	B	Matt McLain HR (Cincinnati Reds @ Philadelphia Phillies)	775	13.2%	11.4%	+1.8 pts	+0.16	655	5 HR in 45 current games, 15 prior-year HR, 2 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.6%, SLG allowed 0.522; Citizens Bank Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
15	B	Ramon Laureano HR (Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres)	875	12.6%	10.3%	+2.3 pts	+0.23	695	5 HR in 43 current games, 24 prior-year HR, 0 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.1%, SLG allowed 0.399; Petco Park 0.94x HR context (wind helping carry, 62F).
16	C	Nathaniel Lowe HR (Cincinnati Reds @ Philadelphia Phillies)	575	16.1%	14.8%	+1.3 pts	+0.09	521	6 HR in 32 current games, 18 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.6%, SLG allowed 0.522; Citizens Bank Park 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
17	B	Daulton Varsho HR (Toronto Blue Jays @ New York Yankees)	750	13.3%	11.8%	+1.6 pts	+0.13	650	5 HR in 43 current games, 22 prior-year HR, 1 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 3.3%, SLG allowed 0.365; Yankee Stadium 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
18	C	Andy Pages HR (Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres)	725	13.3%	12.1%	+1.2 pts	+0.10	652	10 HR in 47 current games, 27 prior-year HR, 2 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 2.0%, SLG allowed 0.294; Petco Park 0.94x HR context (wind helping carry, 62F).
19	B	Ryan Vilade HR (Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays)	800	12.7%	11.1%	+1.6 pts	+0.15	685	2 HR in 24 current games, 0 prior-year HR, 2 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 3.2%, SLG allowed 0.453; Tropicana Field 1.00x HR context (weather unavailable).
20	Spec	Xander Bogaerts HR (Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres)	1000	11.6%	9.1%	+2.5 pts	+0.28	761	7 HR in 45 current games, 11 prior-year HR, 0 HR last 10; starter HR/BF 4.1%, SLG allowed 0.399; Petco Park 0.94x HR context (wind helping carry, 62F).

Game Projection Board

Game	Probables	Bovada ML/Total context	Model Score	Win Lean	Total Lean
Cleveland Guardians @ Detroit Tigers	Slade Cecconi vs Framer Valdez	Bovada feed captured in model	4.7-3.9	Cleveland Guardians 58.2%	8.6 projected runs
Baltimore Orioles @ Tampa Bay Rays	Trevor Rogers vs Shane McClanahan	Bovada feed captured in model	3.6-5.2	Tampa Bay Rays 65.6%	8.8 projected runs
Cincinnati Reds @ Philadelphia Phillies	Nick Lodolo vs Andrew Painter	Bovada feed captured in model	4.9-5.8	Philadelphia Phillies 58.6%	10.7 projected runs
Atlanta Braves @ Miami Marlins	JR Ritchie vs Max Meyer	Bovada feed captured in model	4.5-3.7	Atlanta Braves 57.6%	8.3 projected runs
New York Mets @ Washington Nationals	Christian Scott vs Jake Irvin	Bovada feed captured in model	5.0-4.7	New York Mets 52.1%	9.7 projected runs
Toronto Blue Jays @ New York Yankees	Patrick Corbin vs Ryan Weathers	Bovada feed captured in model	3.8-4.3	New York Yankees 55.2%	8.1 projected runs
Boston Red Sox @ Kansas City Royals	Sonny Gray vs Seth Lugo	Bovada feed captured in model	3.6-3.7	Kansas City Royals 51.0%	7.4 projected runs
Houston Astros @ Minnesota Twins	Tatsuya Imai vs Kendry Rojas	Bovada feed captured in model	3.4-5.1	Minnesota Twins 65.8%	8.5 projected runs
Milwaukee Brewers @ Chicago Cubs	Brandon Sproat vs Shota Imanaga	Bovada feed captured in model	4.2-4.4	Chicago Cubs 51.9%	8.7 projected runs
Texas Rangers @ Colorado Rockies	MacKenzie Gore vs Jose Quintana	Bovada feed captured in model	4.2-4.2	Texas Rangers 50.4%	8.4 projected runs
Athletics @ Los Angeles Angels	J.T. Ginn vs Walbert Ureña	Bovada feed captured in model	4.8-3.6	Athletics 61.3%	8.4 projected runs
Los Angeles Dodgers @ San Diego Padres	Yoshinobu Yamamoto vs Michael King	Bovada feed captured in model	4.4-3.8	Los Angeles Dodgers 55.5%	8.2 projected runs
San Francisco Giants @ Arizona Diamondbacks	Robbie Ray vs Zac Gallen	Bovada feed captured in model	4.2-4.2	San Francisco Giants 50.1%	8.5 projected runs
Chicago White Sox @ Seattle Mariners	Noah Schultz vs Bryan Woo	Bovada feed captured in model	4.7-4.8	Seattle Mariners 50.7%	9.5 projected runs

Method Notes

- Game sides/totals: blended season and last-10 team run creation/prevention, home-field bump, and probable-starter run prevention.
- Pitcher strikeouts: Poisson tail from projected batters faced, pitcher K/BF, last-three workload, and opponent K/PA.
- Hitter props: current-season game-log rates blended with prior-year rates and league priors, adjusted for opposing starter contact profile and projected team runs.
- Home run card: HR/PA blend from current season, last-10 form, prior-year sample, league prior, opposing starter HR/BF and SLG allowed, team HR/PA, game run environment, ballpark factor, and live forecast-hour weather.
- Implied probabilities are no-vig for paired two-way markets and raw implied for one-sided player/alternate markets.